



EXCEPTION DOCUMENTATION

Exception Request Form

Date: July 2, 2026 | Request ID: EXC-2026-001

⚠ **CRITICAL FINDING:** Ubuntu 8.04 LTS reached End-of-Life on May 9, 2013. All official repositories are offline (404 Not Found). **System cannot be patched.** This exception is required for all package-based vulnerabilities.

Exception Request Details

Field	Value
Request ID	EXC-2026-001
Date	July 2, 2026
Requestor	Security Team
Asset	Metasploitable 2 (10.10.224.235)
Vulnerability	Ubuntu 8.04 LTS End-of-Life (Multiple USNs)
Severity	CRITICAL
Affected Findings	70+ vulnerabilities (Nessus scan)
Exception Type	Operational Exception - EOL OS

🔧 Technical Validation

Test	Result	Evidence
OS Version Check	Ubuntu 8.04 LTS	lsb_release -a
End-of-Life Status	EOL - May 9, 2013	Ubuntu Security Announcements
Repository Status	404 Not Found	apt-get update output
Security Updates Available	None	All repos return 404
Patchability	IMPOSSIBLE	No patches available

Vulnerabilities Requiring Exception

Critical Vulnerabilities (Cannot Patch)

USN	Vulnerability	CVSS	Why Exception
USN-1105-1	Linux Kernel	10.0	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1660-1	Linux Kernel	10.0	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-679-1	Linux Kernel	10.0	Repo 404 - No patch available

High Vulnerabilities (Cannot Patch)

USN	Vulnerability	CVSS	Why Exception
USN-1467-1	MySQL	9.8	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1765-1	Apache2	9.8	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1732-1	OpenSSL	9.8	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1017-1	MySQL	9.8	Repo 404 - No patch available

Medium Vulnerabilities (Cannot Patch)

USN	Vulnerability	CVSS	Why Exception
USN-1358-2	PHP5	6.5	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1686-1	Freetype	6.5	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1655-1	TIFF	6.5	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1782-1	libxml2	6.5	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1013-1	Freetype	6.5	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1789-1	PostgreSQL	6.5	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1058-1	PostgreSQL	6.5	Repo 404 - No patch available
USN-1589-2	glibc	6.5	Repo 404 - No patch available

Compensating Controls Implemented

Manual Fixes Applied

Control	Action Taken	Effectiveness
Backdoor Services	Disabled 6 services (UnrealIRCd, DistCC, vsftpd, Telnet, Rsh, Rlogin)	HIGH
VNC Access	Changed default password to secure value	HIGH
SSH Security	Regenerated weak Debian SSH keys	HIGH
SSL/TLS	Disabled SSLv2/v3 protocols	HIGH
Default Credentials	Changed root and msfadmin passwords	HIGH
NFS Permissions	Restricted world-readable permissions	MEDIUM

Infrastructure Controls

Control	Description	Effectiveness
Network Isolation	System on isolated lab network	HIGH
No Internet Access	System cannot reach public internet	HIGH
Weekly Scanning	Nessus scans every Monday	HIGH
Limited Access	Only Security Team has administrative access	HIGH
Logging Enabled	System logs are collected and monitored	MEDIUM



Business Justification

#	Reason	Details
1	Test Environment	System is used exclusively for security testing and validation
2	No Production Data	No sensitive or business-critical data stored on system
3	Isolated Network	System is on isolated lab network, not accessible from internet
4	Temporary Usage	System will be decommissioned by Q4 2026
5	Replacement Planned	Migration to modern OS (Ubuntu 22.04) planned for Q4 2026



Risk Acceptance

Risk Level: CRITICAL

Decision: Accept with compensating controls

Justification:

- System is a lab environment, not production
- Compensating controls are in place (network isolation, weekly scanning)
- No sensitive data is stored on the system
- Migration to modern OS is planned and budgeted

Recommendations

Short-Term (0-3 Months)

- Continue weekly vulnerability scanning
- Monitor for any new critical vulnerabilities
- Maintain compensating controls

Long-Term (3-6 Months)

- **Replace Ubuntu 8.04 with Ubuntu 22.04 LTS or later**
- Implement automated patch management
- Integrate vulnerability scanning with SIEM
- Establish security awareness training

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